Chapter 8

Switching

Figure 8.1 *Switched network*

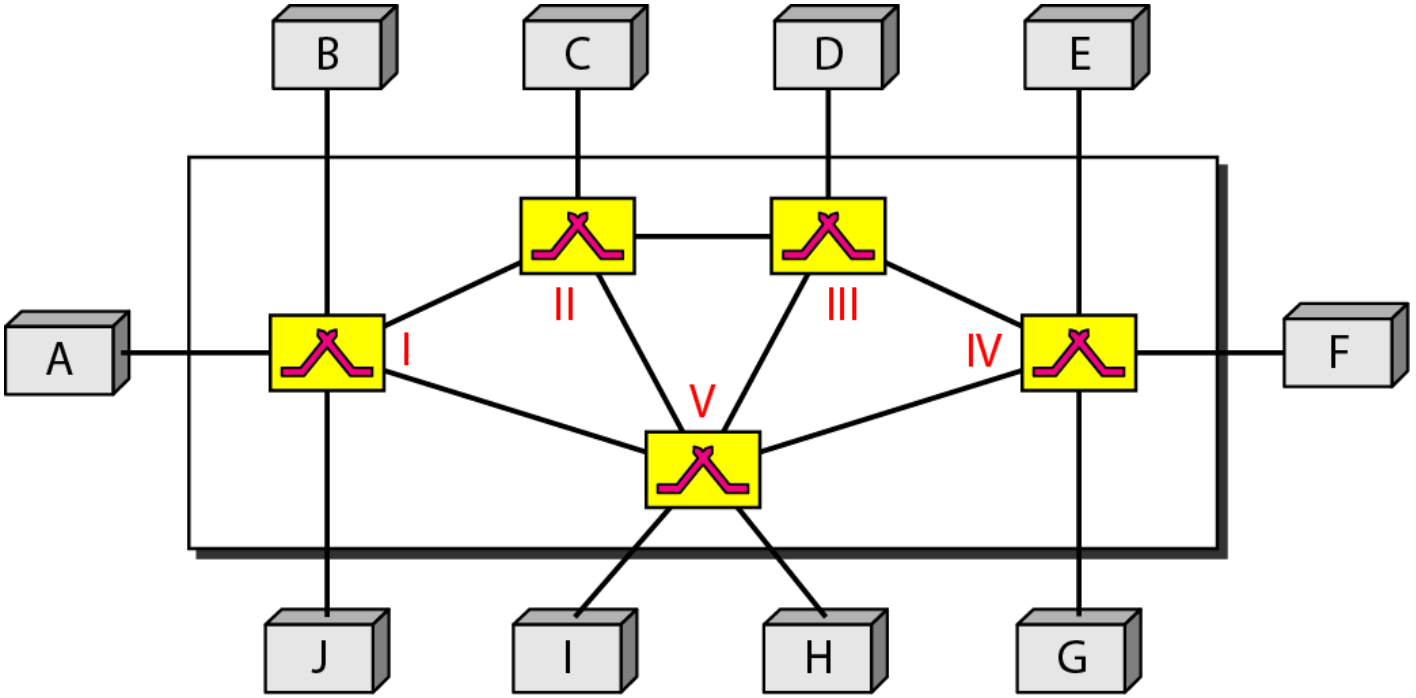
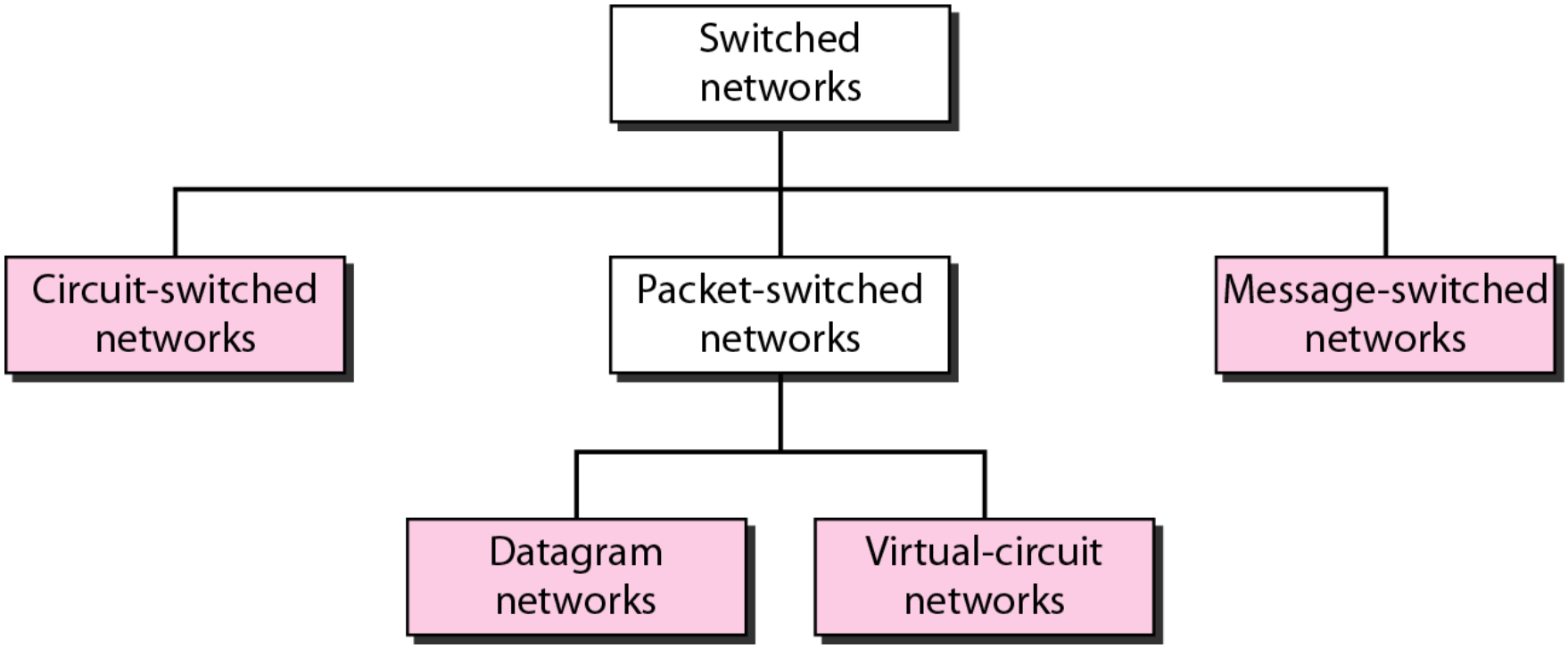


Figure 8.2 *Taxonomy of switched networks*



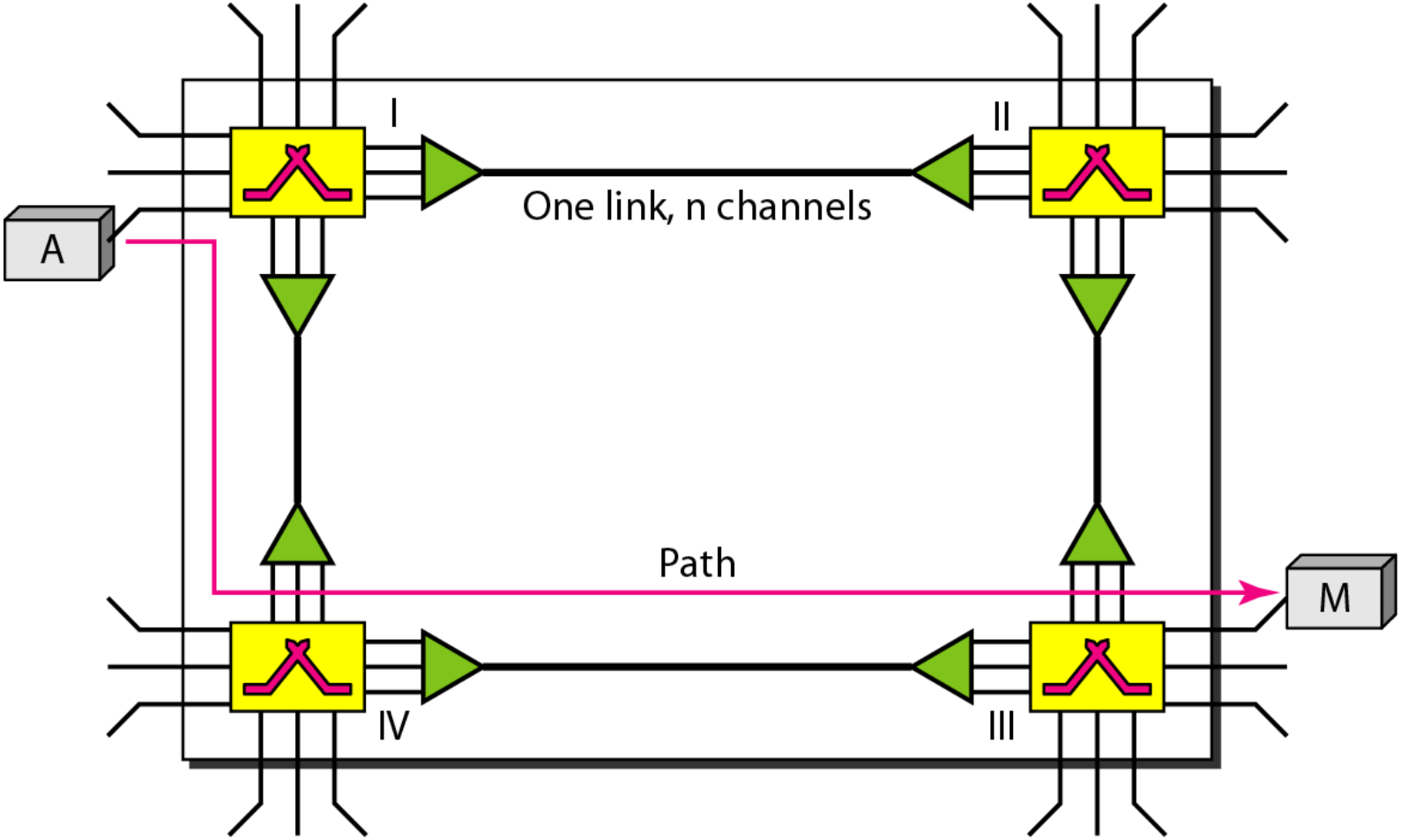
8-1 CIRCUIT-SWITCHED NETWORKS

A circuit-switched network consists of a set of switches connected by physical links. A connection between two stations is a dedicated path made of one or more links. However, each connection uses only one dedicated channel on each link. Each link is normally divided into n channels by using FDM or TDM.

Note

A circuit-switched network is made of a set of switches connected by physical links, in which each link is divided into *n* channels.

Figure 8.3 *A trivial circuit-switched network*



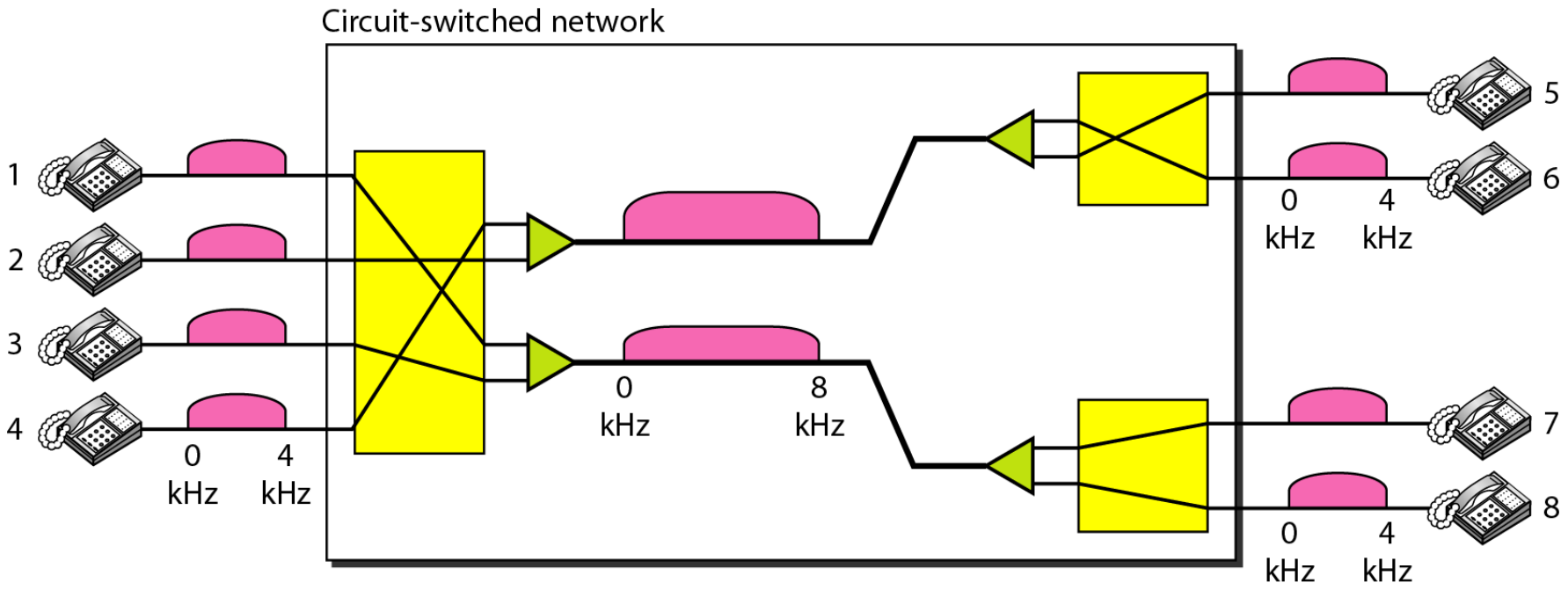
Note

In circuit switching, the resources need to be reserved during the setup phase; the resources remain dedicated for the entire duration of data transfer until the teardown phase.

Example 8.1

As a trivial example, let us use a circuit-switched network to connect eight telephones in a small area. Communication is through 4-kHz voice channels. We assume that each link uses FDM to connect a maximum of two voice channels. The bandwidth of each link is then 8 kHz. Figure 8.4 shows the situation. Telephone 1 is connected to telephone 7; 2 to 5; 3 to 8; and 4 to 6. Of course the situation may change when new connections are made. The switch controls the connections.

Figure 8.4 *Circuit-switched network used in Example 8.1*



Example 8.2

As another example, consider a circuit-switched network that connects computers in two remote offices of a private company. The offices are connected using a T-1 line leased from a communication service provider. There are two 4 × 8 (4 inputs and 8 outputs) switches in this network. For each switch, four output ports are folded into the input ports to allow communication between computers in the same office. Four other output ports allow communication between the two offices. Figure 8.5 shows the situation.

Figure 8.5 *Circuit-switched network used in Example 8.2*

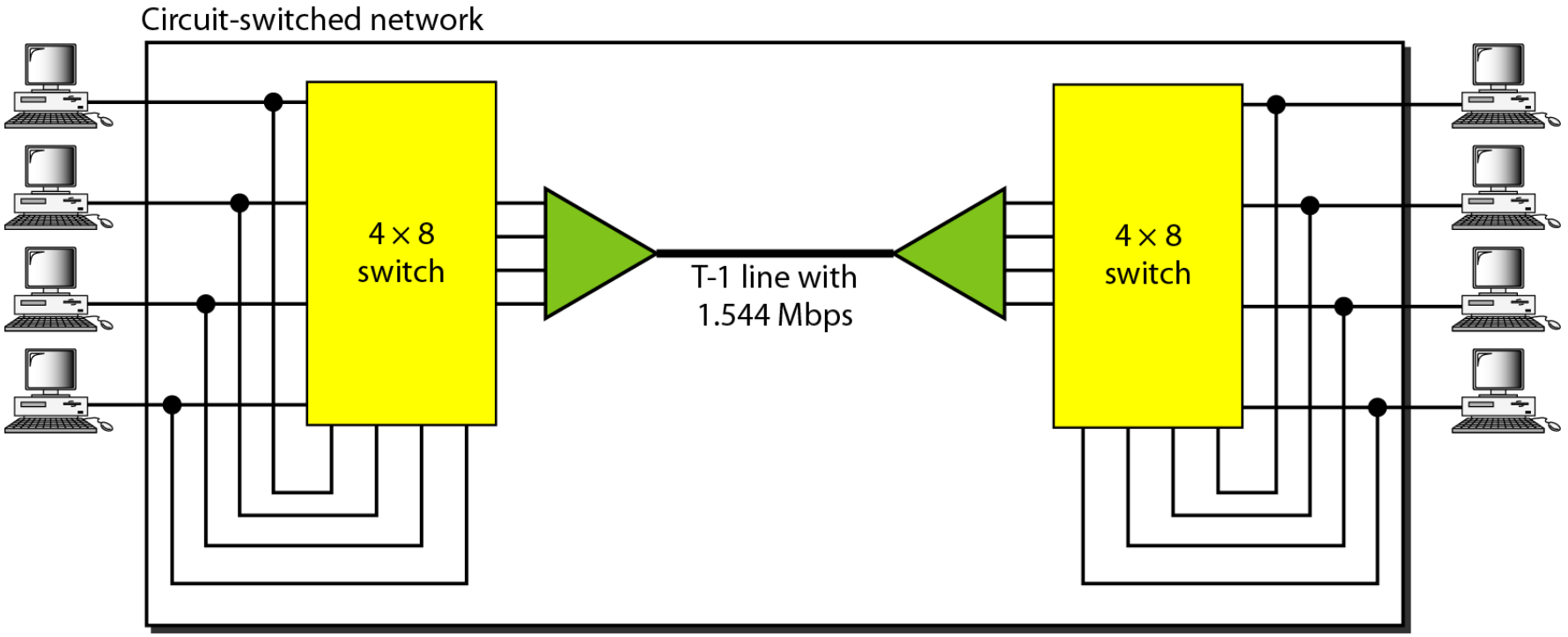
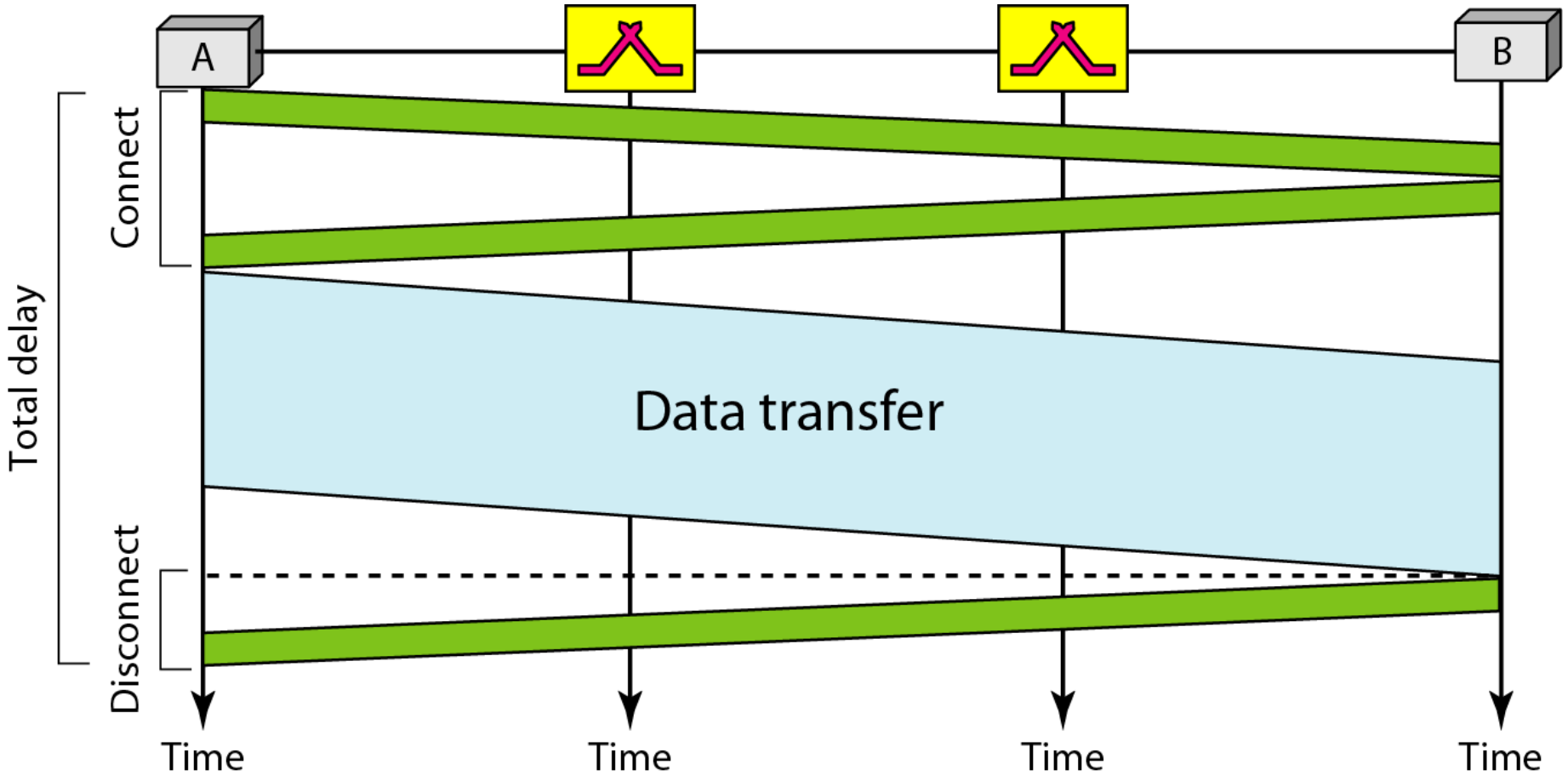


Figure 8.6 *Delay in a circuit-switched network*



Note

Switching at the physical layer in the traditional telephone network uses the circuit-switching approach.

8-2 DATAGRAM NETWORKS

In data communications, we need to send messages from one end system to another. If the message is going to pass through a packet-switched network, it needs to be divided into packets of fixed or variable size. The size of the packet is determined by the network and the governing protocol.

Note

In a packet-switched network, there is no resource reservation; resources are allocated on demand.

Figure 8.7 *A datagram network with five switches (routers)*

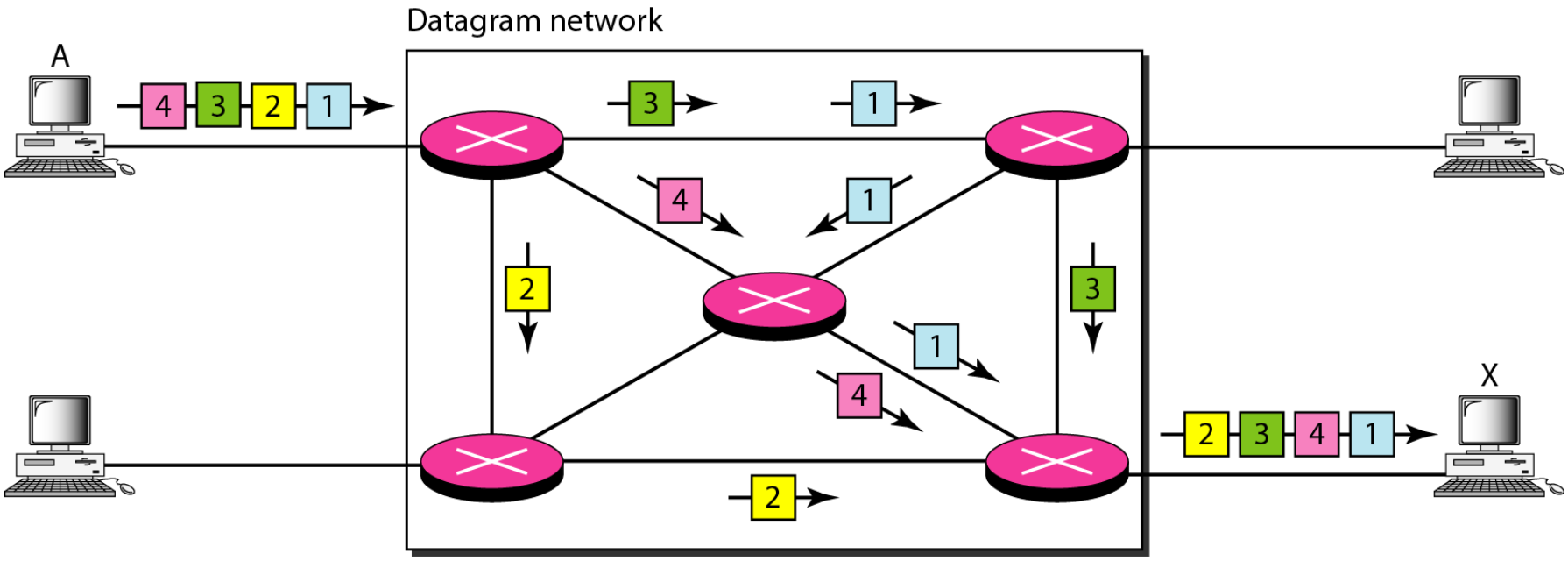
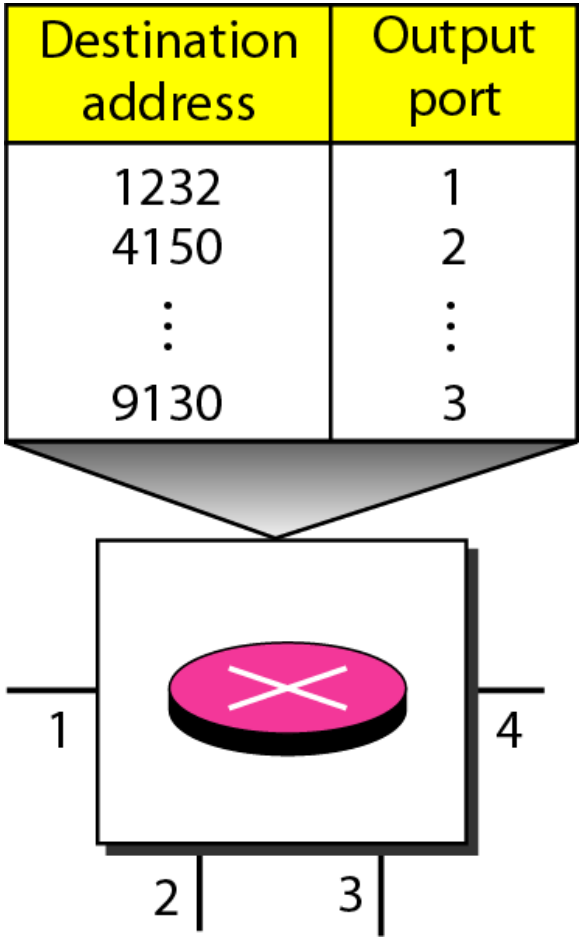


Figure 8.8 *Routing table in a datagram network*



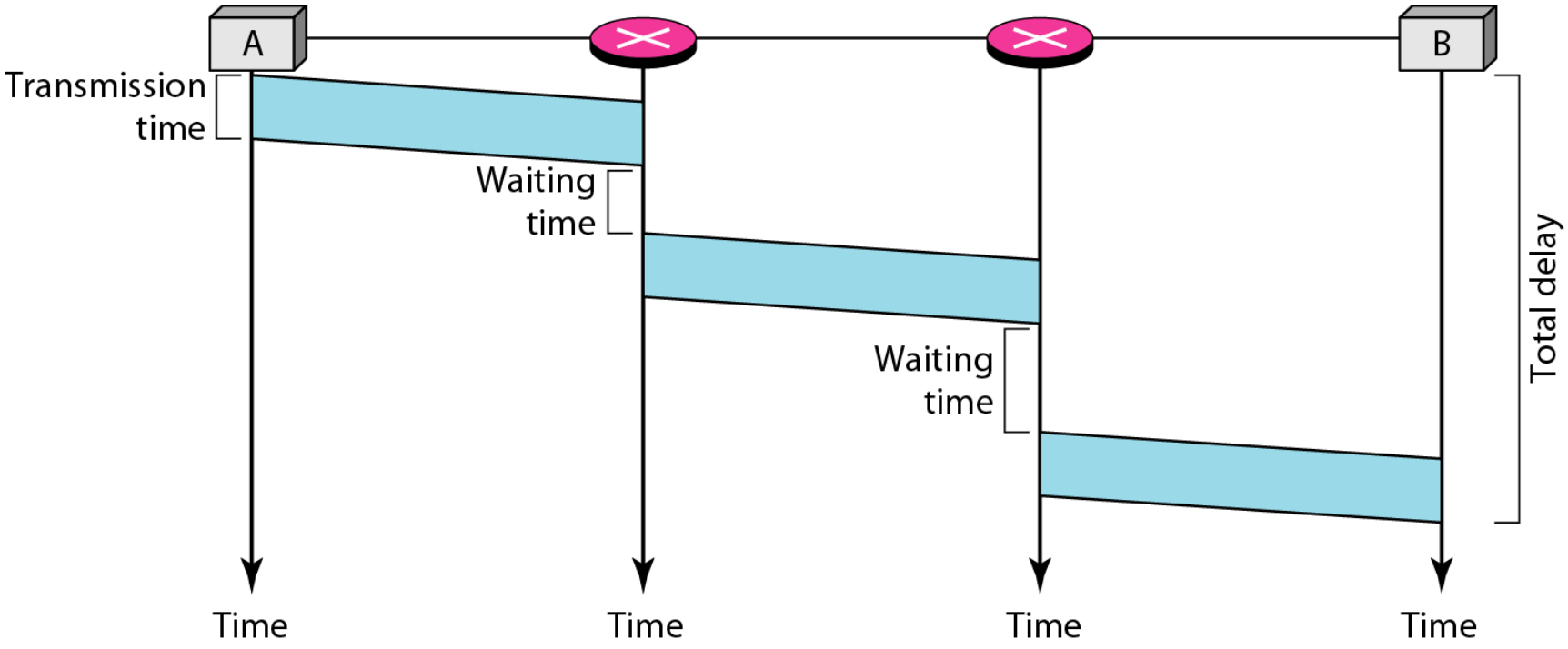
Note

A switch in a datagram network uses a routing table that is based on the destination address.

Note

The destination address in the header of a packet in a datagram network remains the same during the entire journey of the packet.

Figure 8.9 *Delay in a datagram network*



Note

Switching in the Internet is done by using the datagram approach to packet switching at the network layer.

8-3 VIRTUAL-CIRCUIT NETWORKS

A virtual-circuit network is a cross between a circuit-switched network and a datagram network. It has some characteristics of both.

Figure 8.10 *Virtual-circuit network*

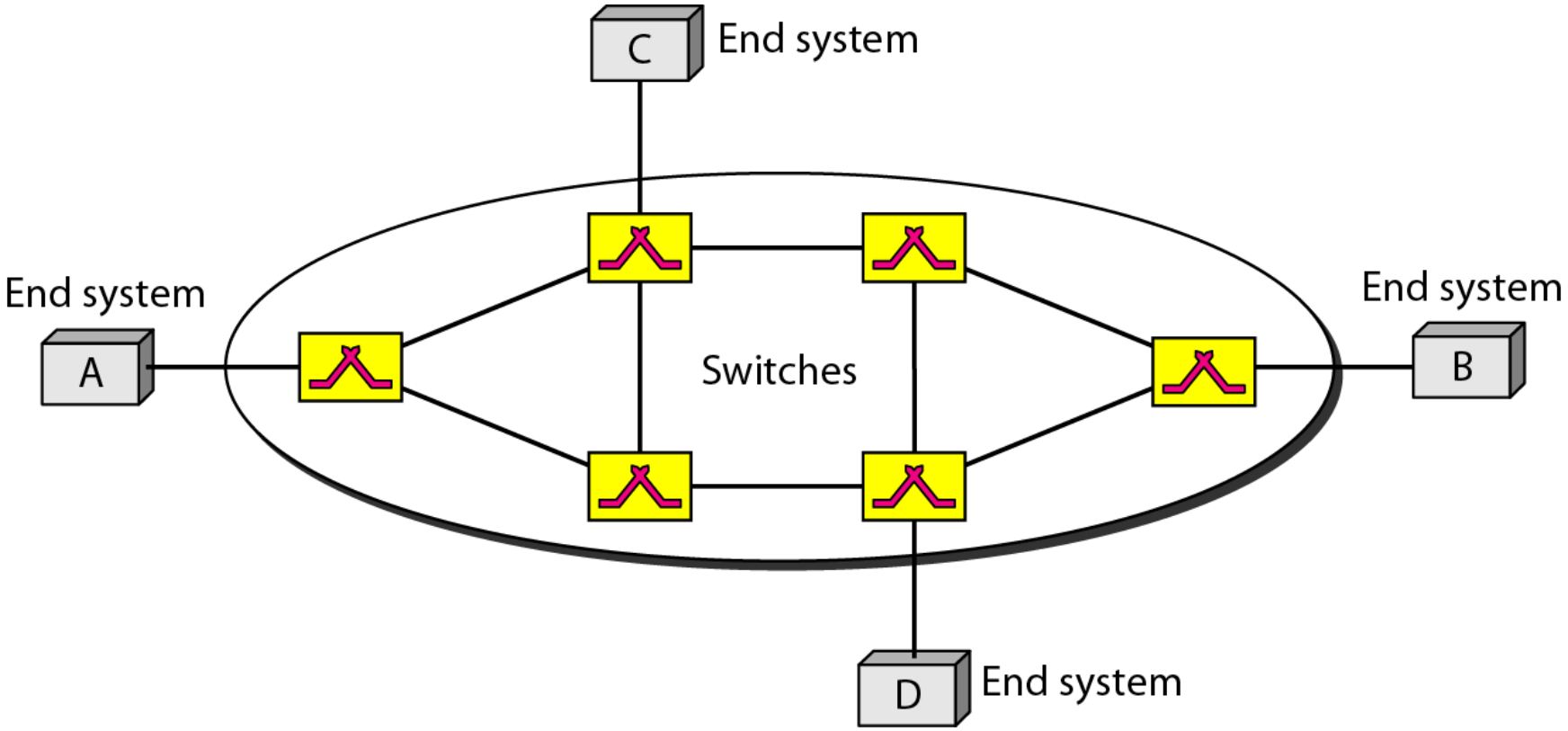


Figure 8.11 *Virtual-circuit identifier*

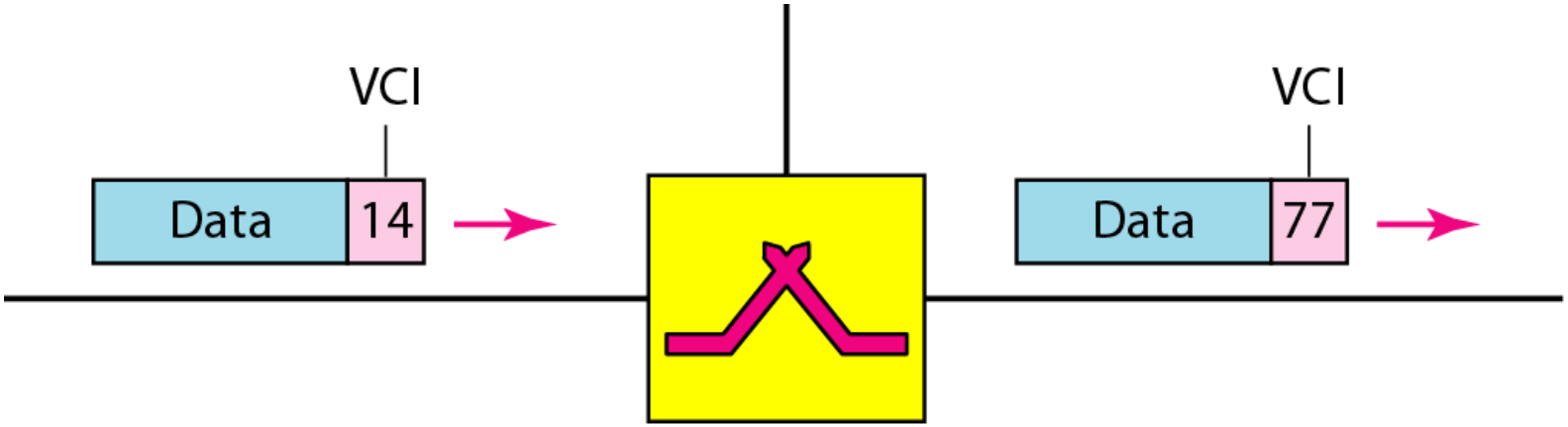


Figure 8.12 *Switch and tables in a virtual-circuit network*

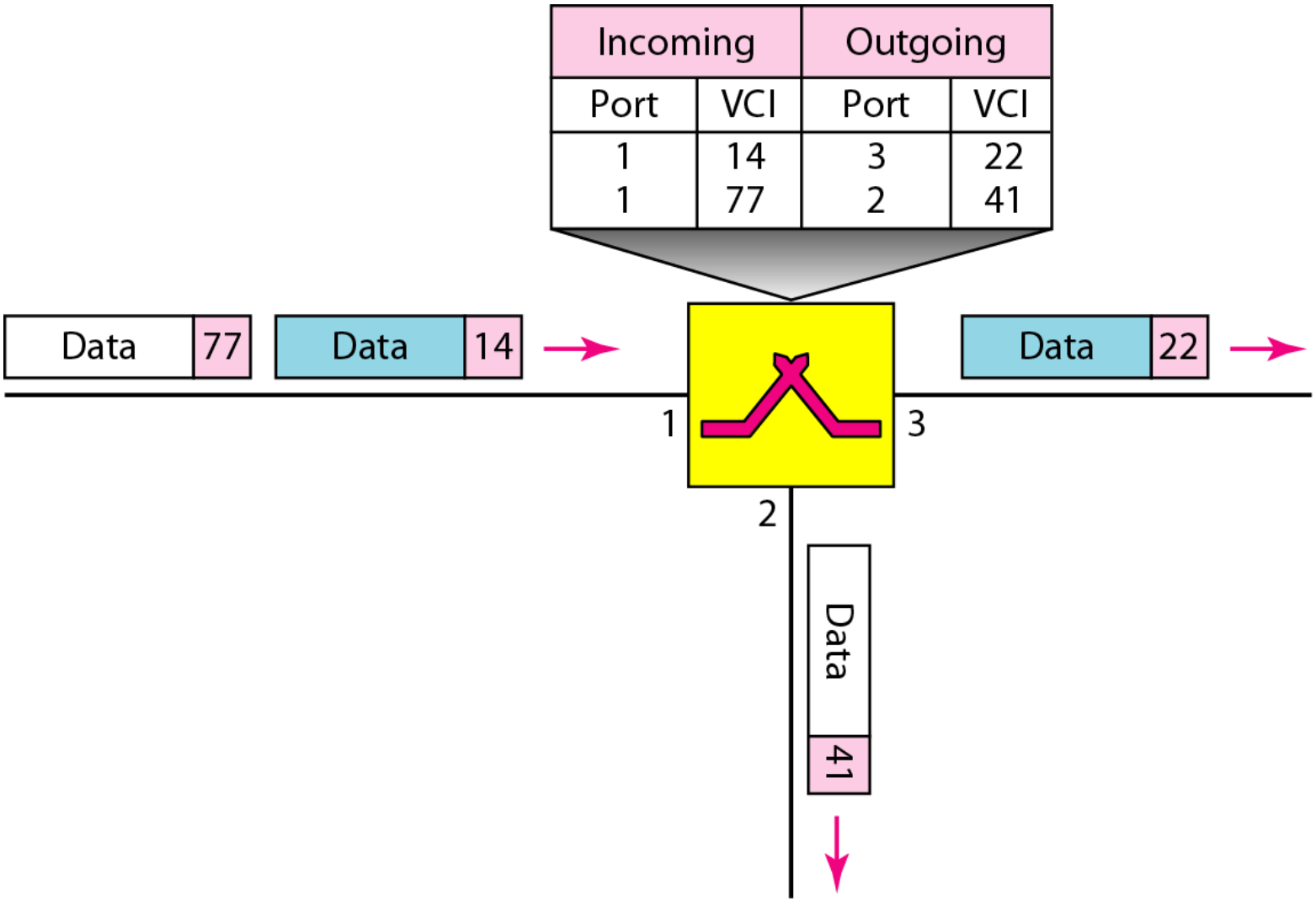


Figure 8.13 *Source-to-destination data transfer in a virtual-circuit network*

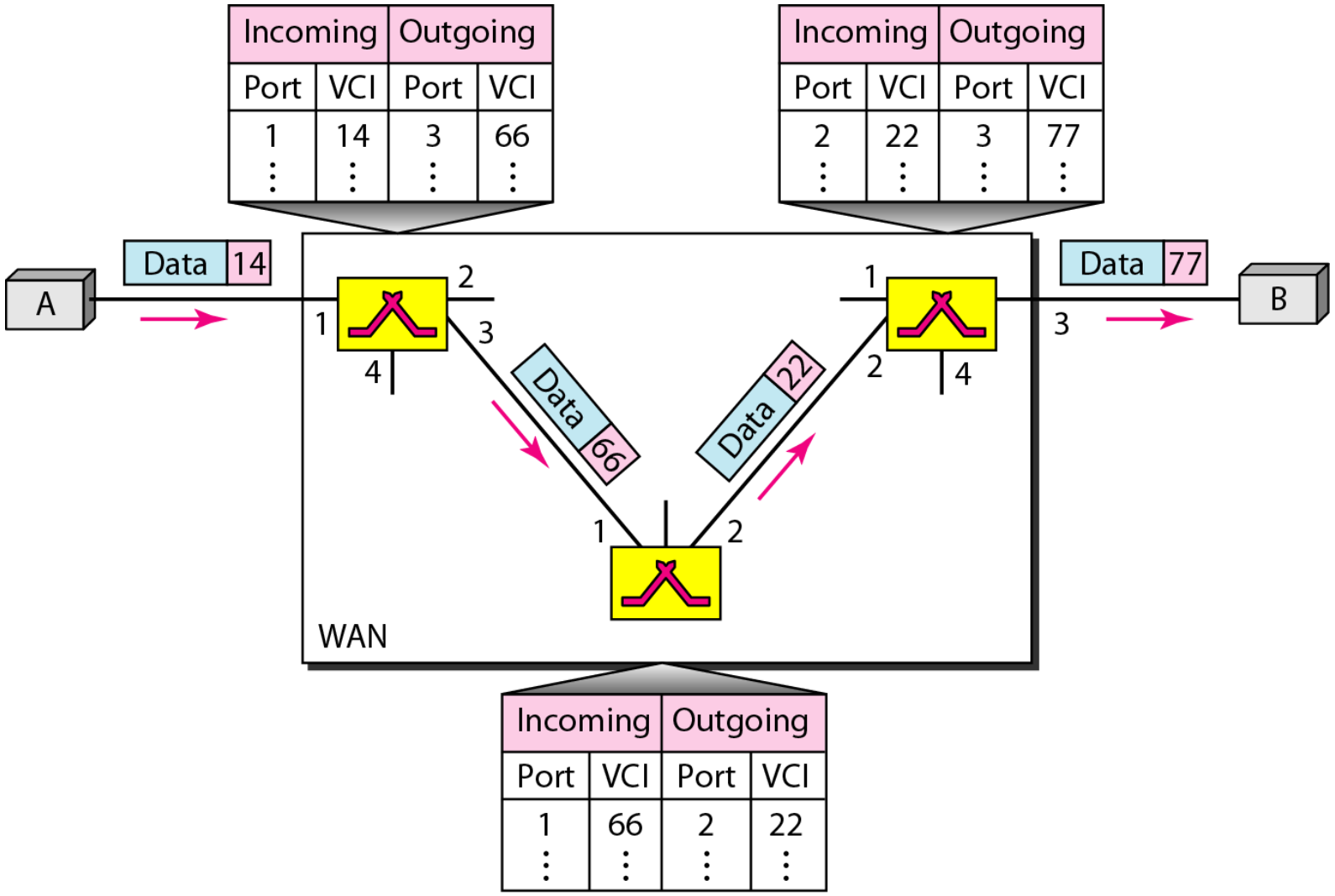


Figure 8.14 *Setup request in a virtual-circuit network*

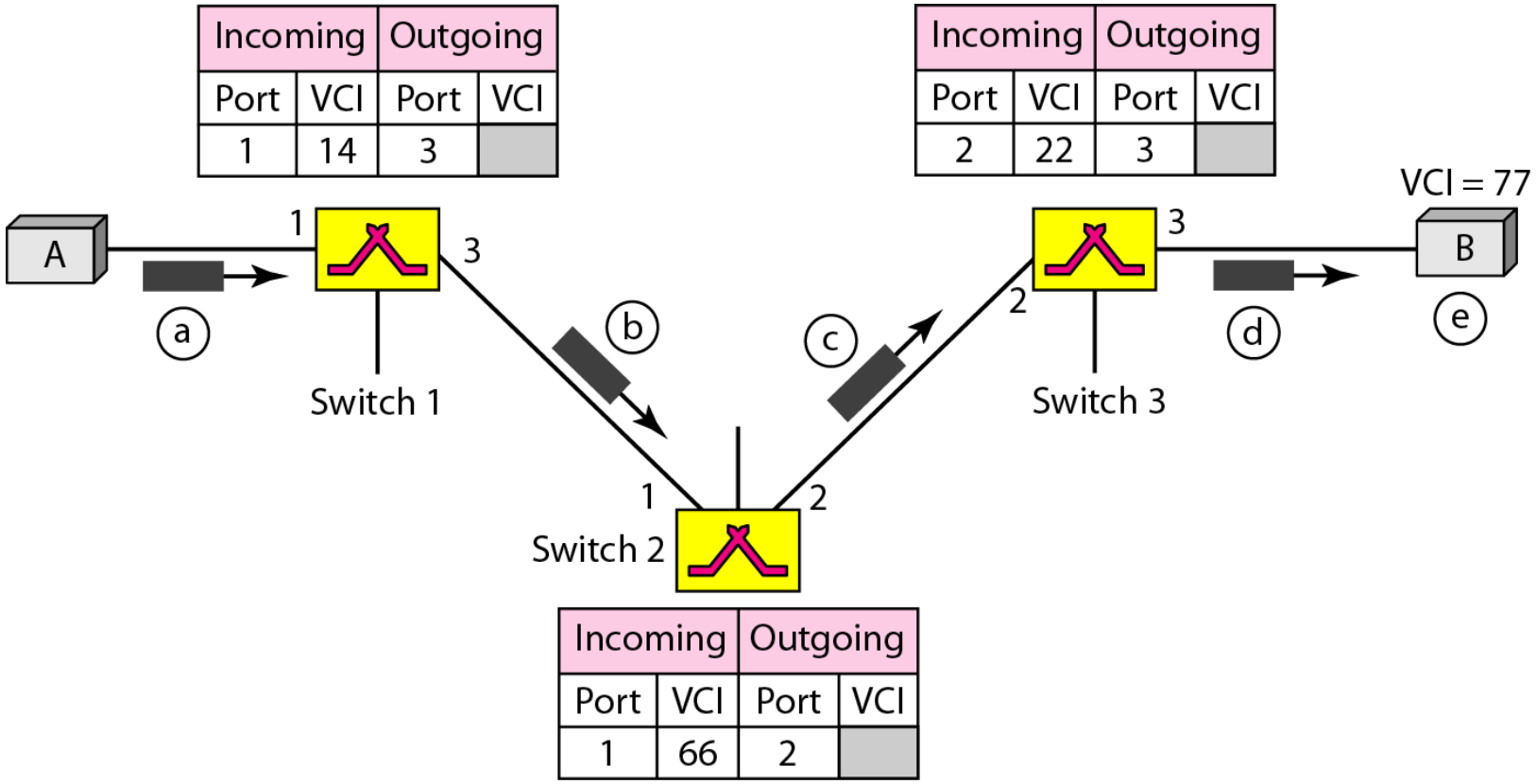
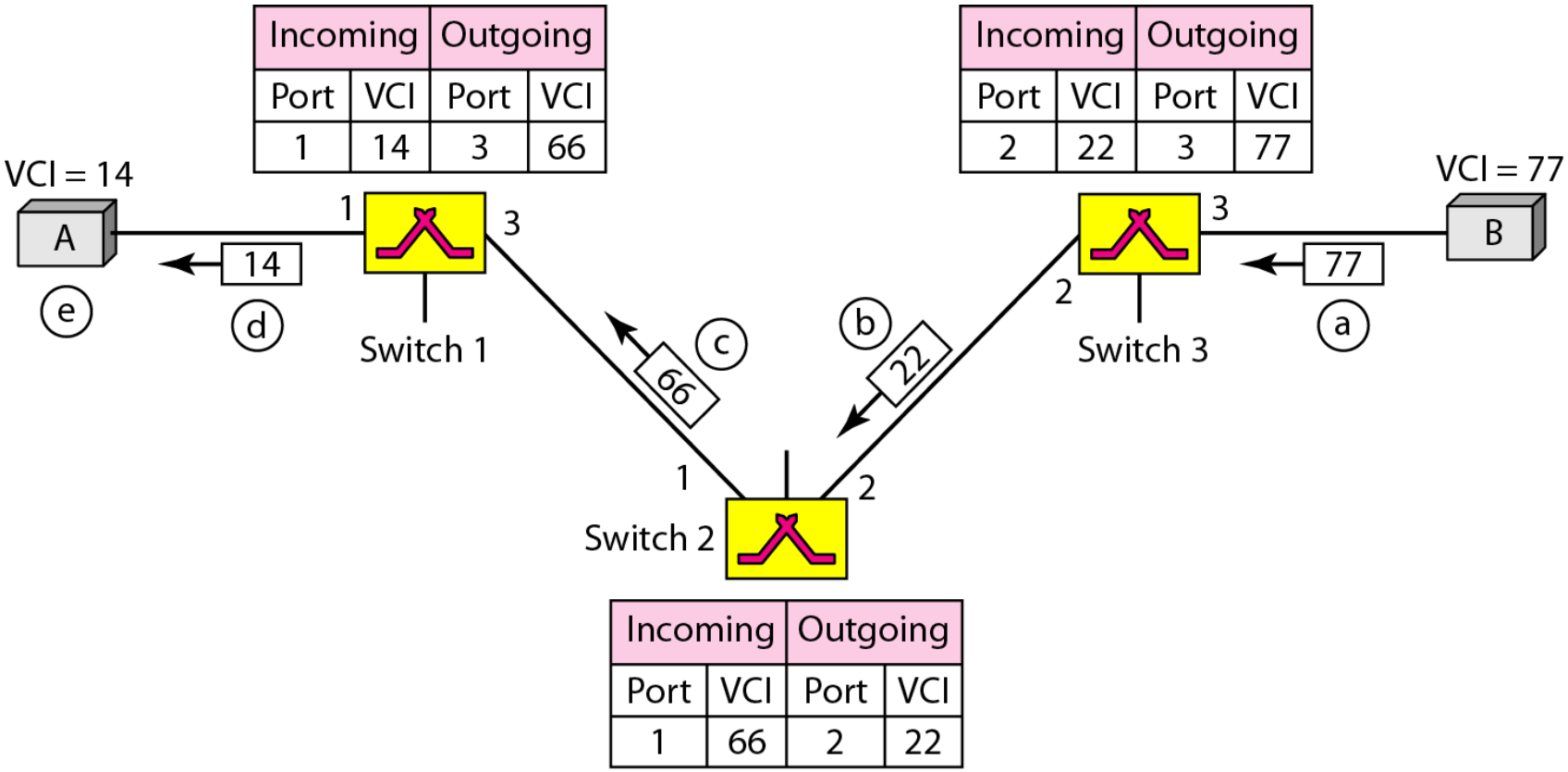


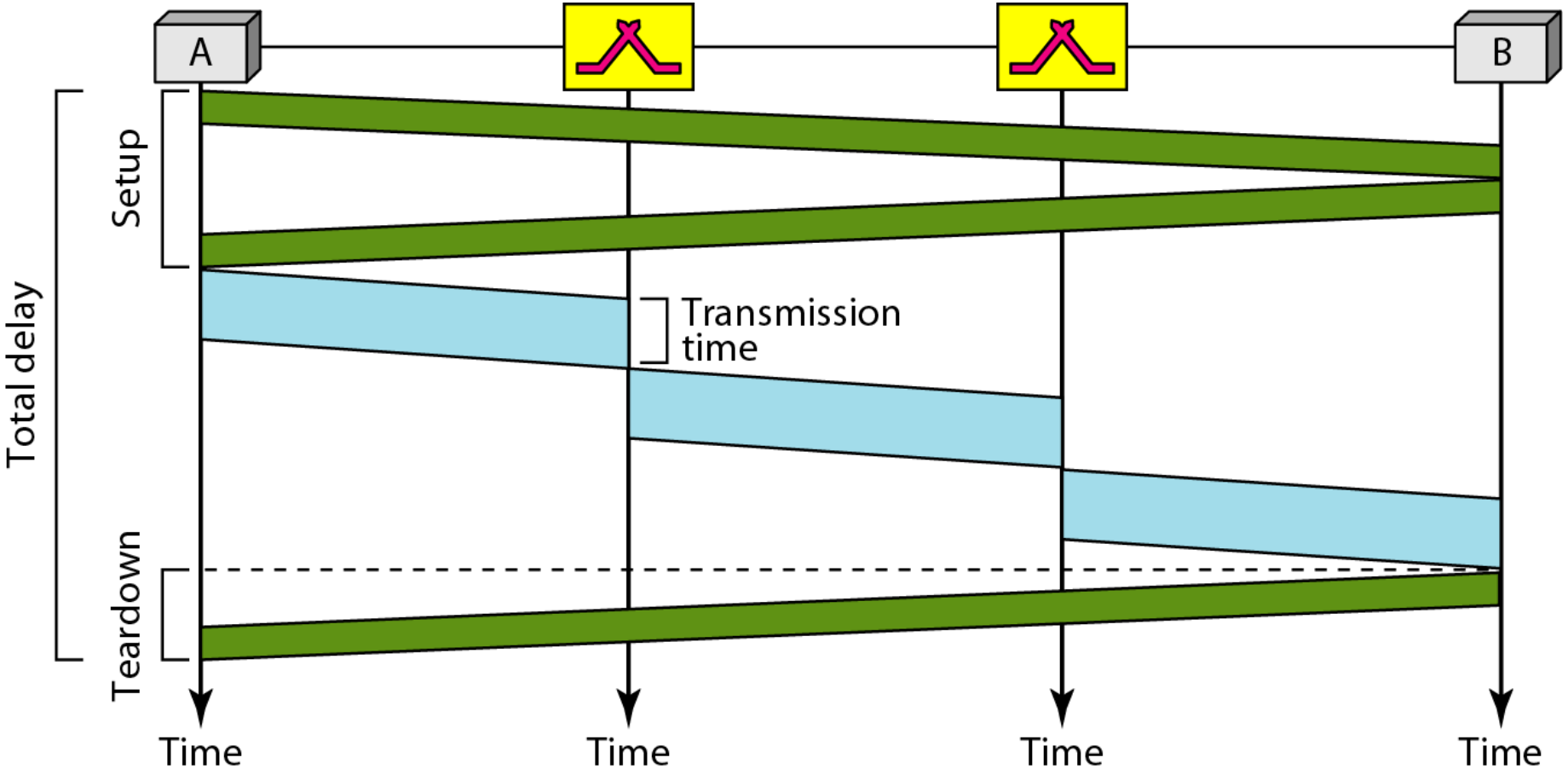
Figure 8.15 *Setup acknowledgment in a virtual-circuit network*



Note

In virtual-circuit switching, all packets belonging to the same source and destination travel the same path; but the packets may arrive at the destination with different delays .

Figure 8.16 *Delay in a virtual-circuit network*



Note

Switching at the data link layer in a switched WAN is normally implemented by using virtual-circuit techniques.

8-4 STRUCTURE OF A SWITCH

We use switches in circuit-switched and packet-switched networks. In this section, we discuss the structures of the switches used in each type of network.

Space-Division Switch

Figure 8.17 *Crossbar switch with three inputs and four outputs*

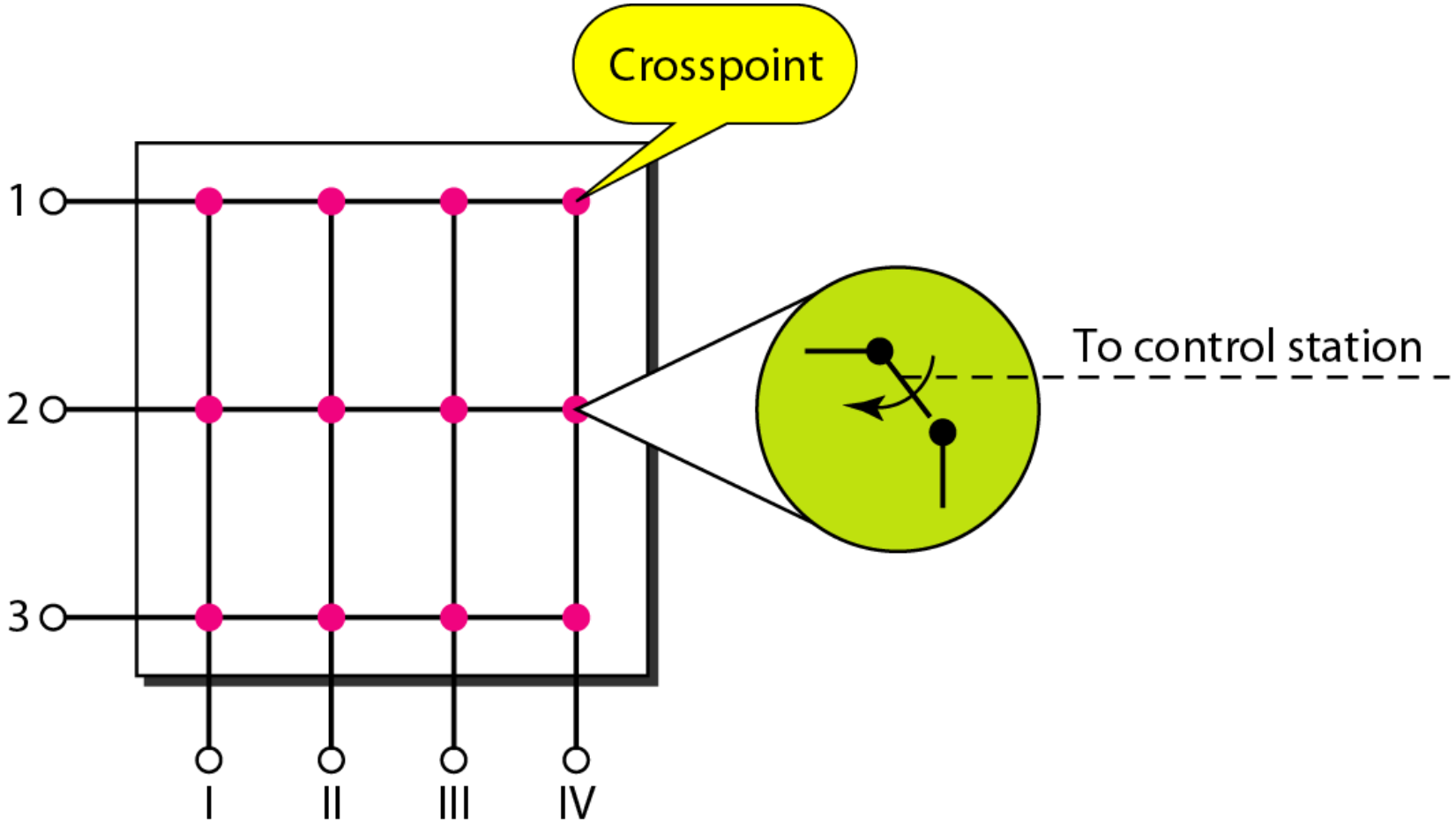
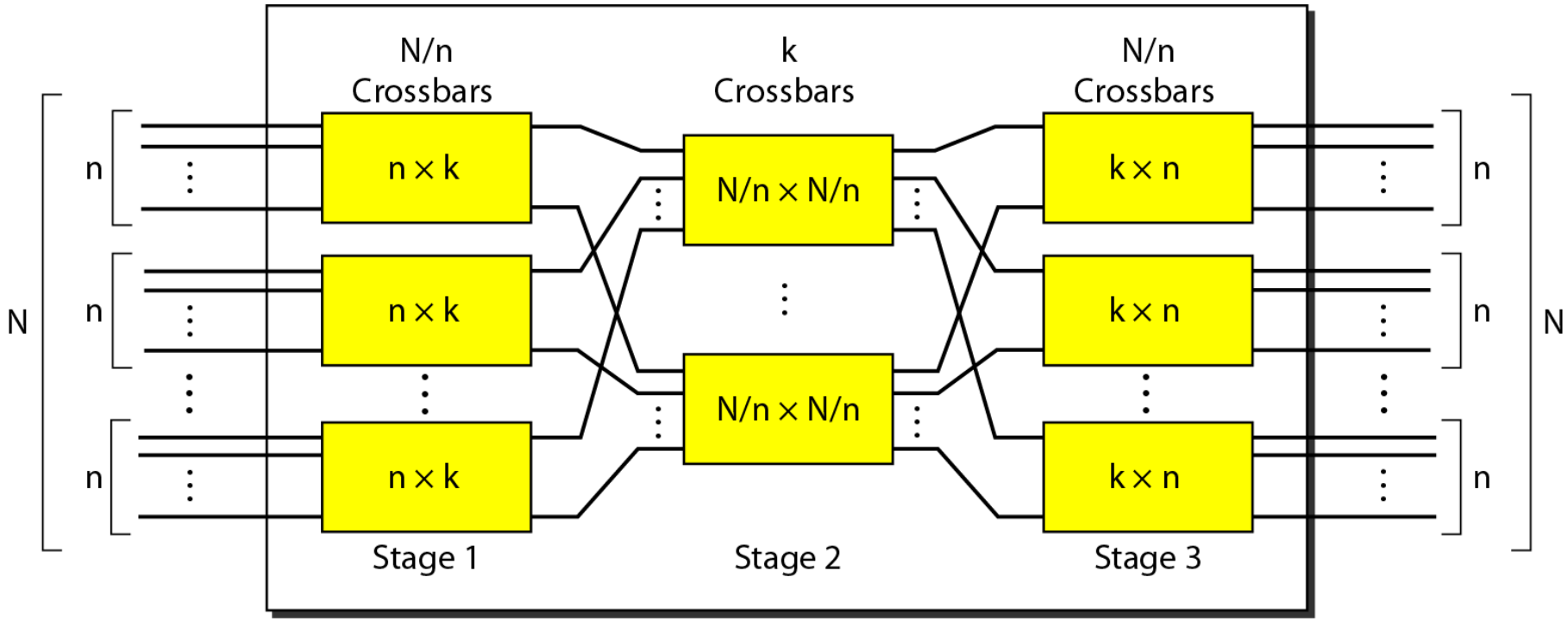


Figure 8.18 *Multistage switch*



Note

In a three-stage switch, the total number of crosspoints is $2kN + k(N/n)^2$ which is much smaller than the number of crosspoints in a single-stage switch (N^2).

Example 8.3

Design a three-stage, 200 × 200 switch (N = 200) with k = 4 and n = 20.

Solution

In the first stage we have N/n or 10 crossbars, each of size 20 × 4. In the second stage, we have 4 crossbars, each of size 10 × 10. In the third stage, we have 10 crossbars, each of size 4 × 20. The total number of crosspoints is $2kN + k(N/n)^2$, or 2000 crosspoints. This is 5 percent of the number of crosspoints in a single-stage switch (200 × 200 = 40,000).

Blocking

The whole idea of multistage switch is to share the crosspoints in the middle crossbars.

Sharing can cause a lack of availability if the resource are limited.

Blocking refers to times when one input cannot be connected to an output because there is no path available between them-all possible intermediate switches are occupied.

To overcome with blocking, **Clos has given some criterion.**

Note

According to the Clos criterion:

$n = (N/2)^{1/2}$

$k > 2n - 1$

Total number of crosspoints>=4N*[(2N)$^{1/2}$-1]

Example 8.4

Redesign the previous three-stage, 200 × 200 switch, using the Clos criteria with a minimum number of crosspoints.

Solution

We let $n = (200/2)^{1/2}$, or $n = 10$. We calculate $k = 2n - 1 = 19$. In the first stage, we have 200/10, or 20, crossbars, each with 10 × 19 crosspoints. In the second stage, we have 19 crossbars, each with 20 × 20 crosspoints. In the third stage, we have 20 crossbars each with 19 × 10 crosspoints. The total number of crosspoints is 20(10 × 19) + 19(20 × 20) + 20(19 ×10) =15200.

Example 8.5

Design the three-stage, 32 × 32 switch, using the Clos criteria with a minimum number of crosspoints.

Solution

We let $n = (32/2)^{1/2}$, or $n = 4$. We calculate $k = 2n - 1 = 7$. In the first stage, we have 32/4, or 8 crossbars, each with 4 × 7 crosspoints. In the second stage, we have 7 crossbars, each with 8 × 8 crosspoints. In the third stage, we have 8 crossbars each with 7 × 4 crosspoints. The total number of crosspoints is 8(4 × 7) + 7(8 × 8) + 8(7 ×4) =896.

Total number of crosspoints can also be calculated using:

$2kN + k(N/n)^2 = 2*7*32+7*(32/4)^2 = 896$

Time-Division Switch

Figure 8.19 *Time-slot interchange*

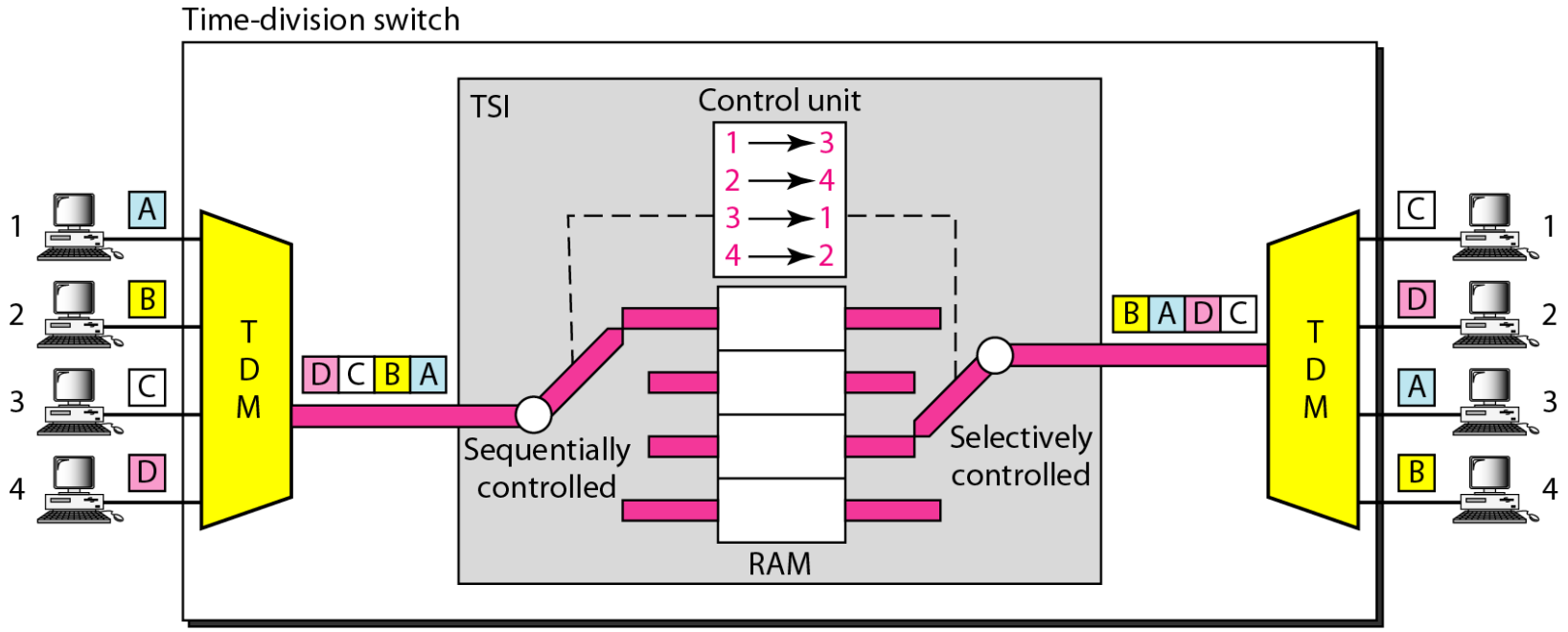


Figure 8.20 *Time-space-time switch (12*12)*

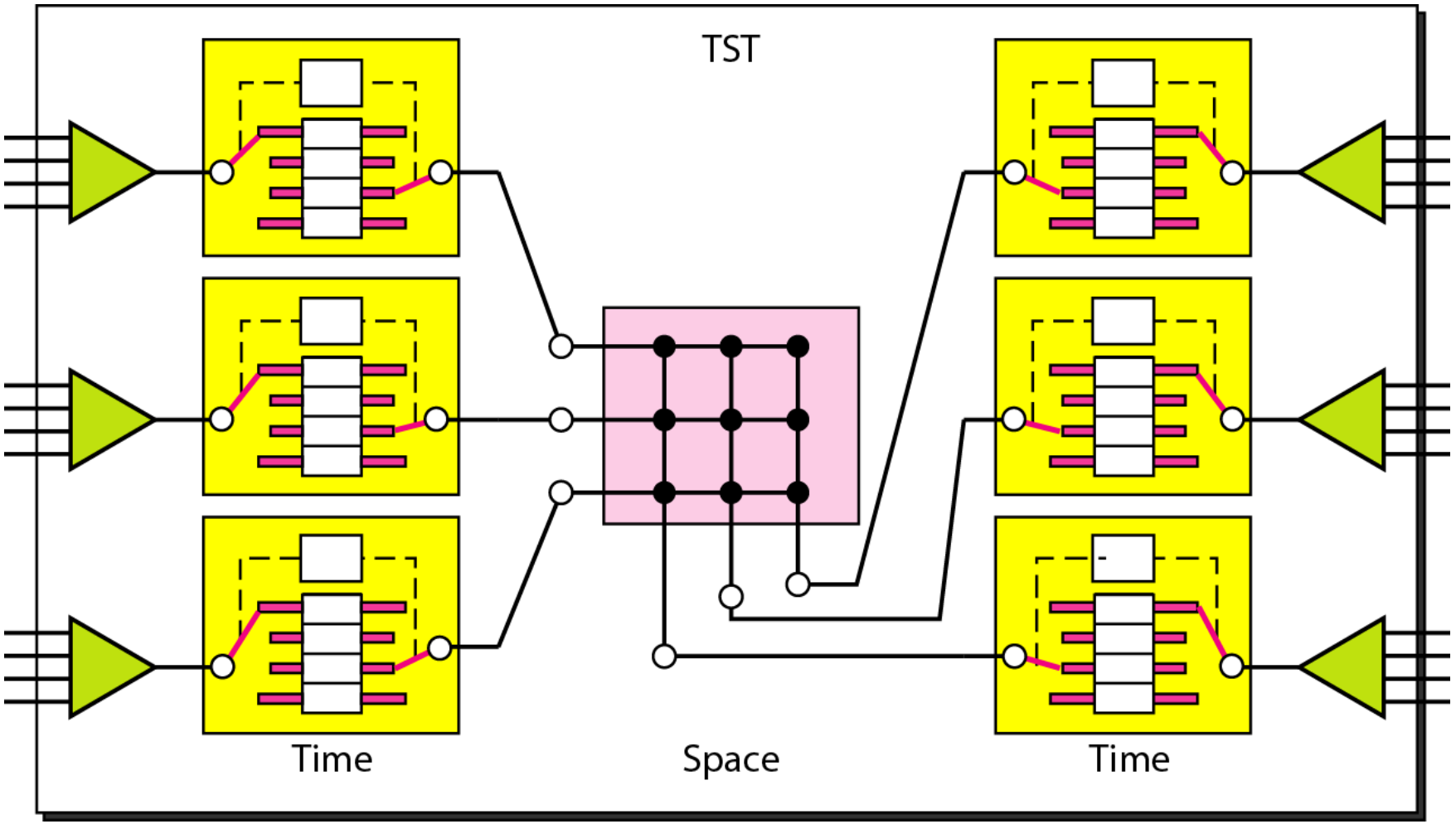


Figure 8.21 *Packet switch components*

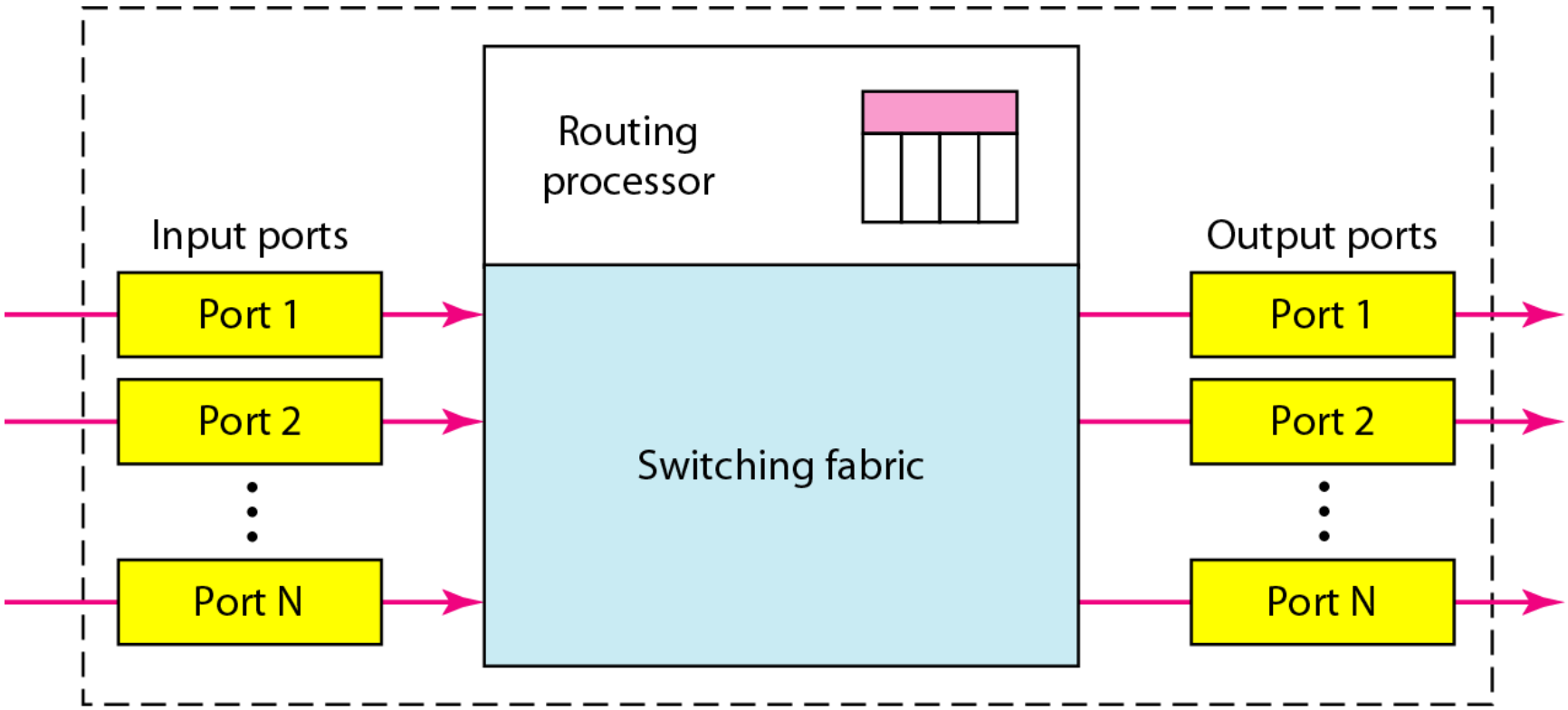


Figure 8.22 *Input port*

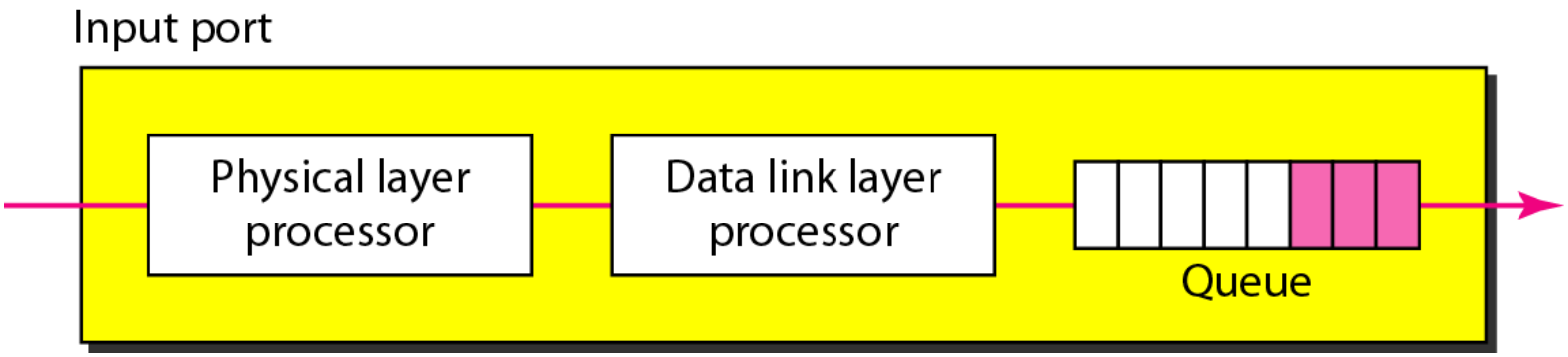


Figure 8.23 *Output port*

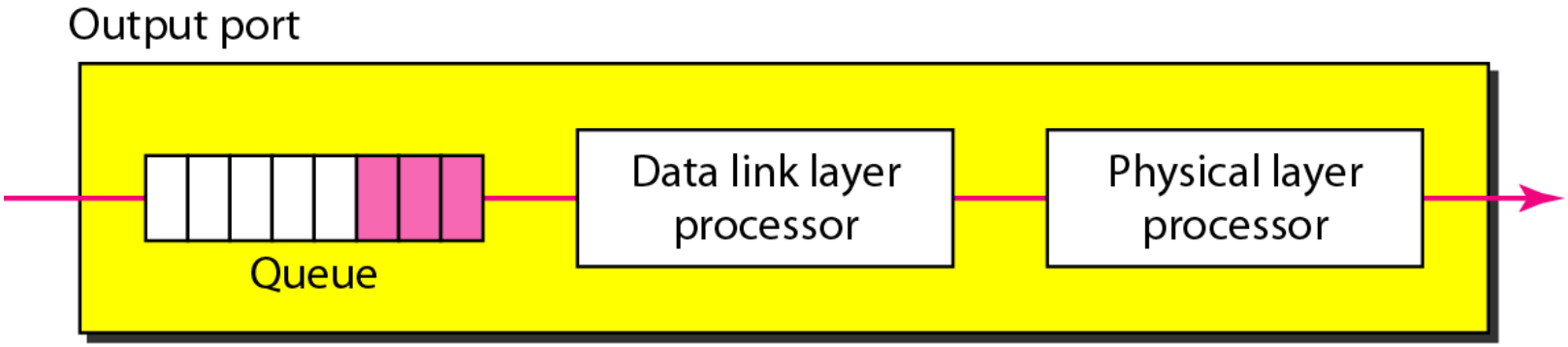


Figure 8.24 *A banyan switch*

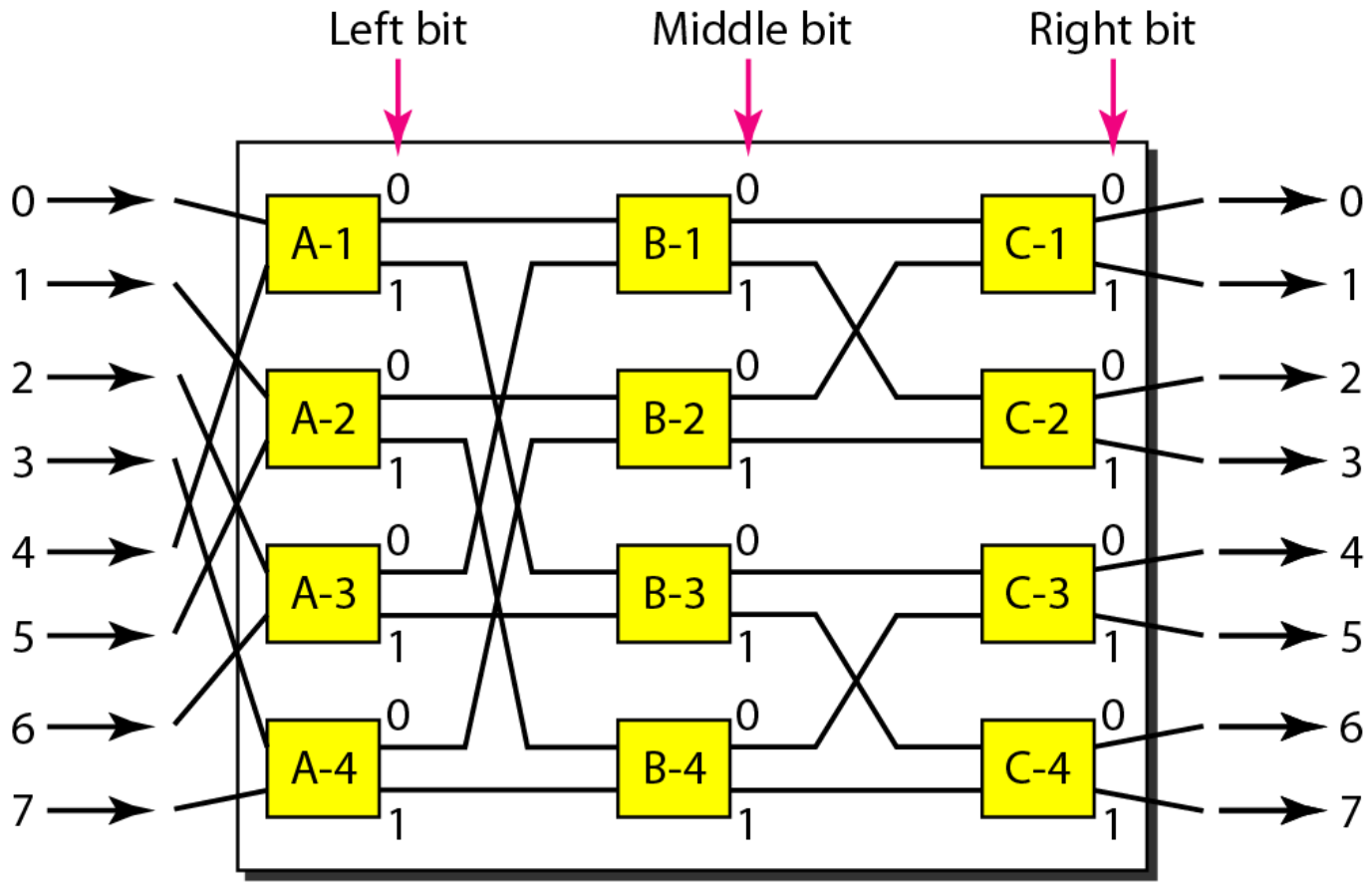
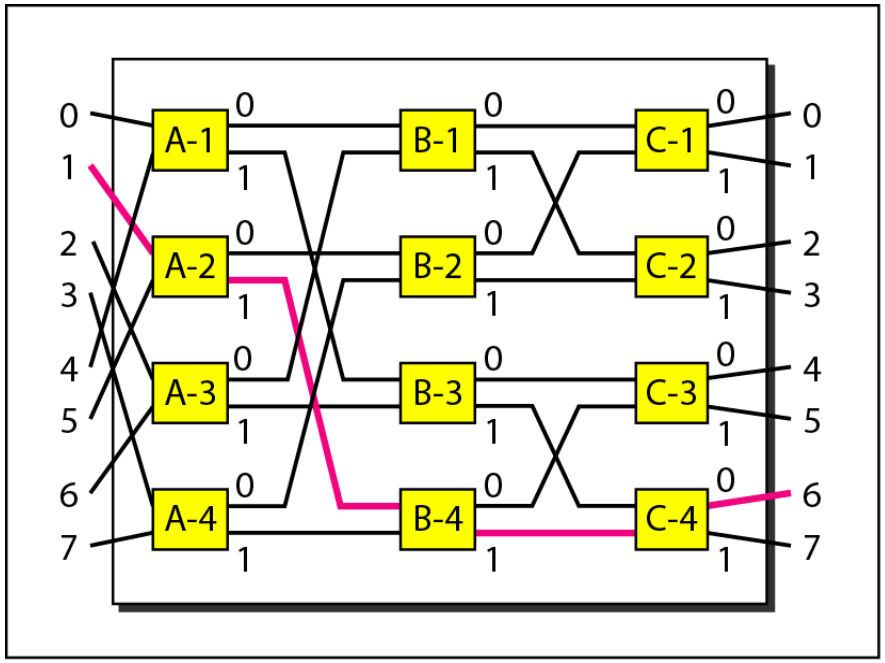
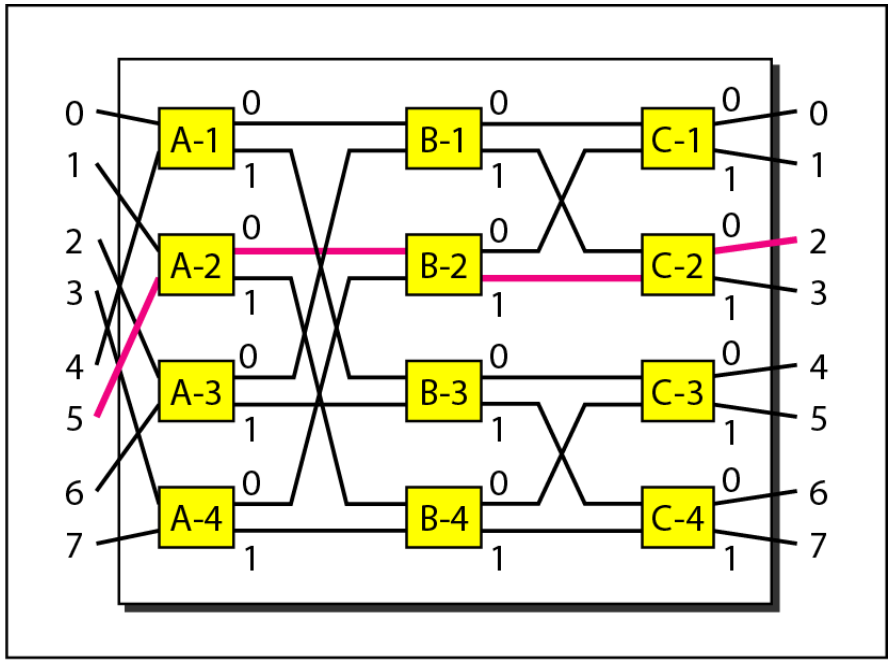


Figure 8.25 *Examples of routing in a banyan switch*



a. Input 1 sending a cell to output 6 (110)



b. Input 5 sending a cell to output 2 (010)

8.5 Message Switched Network

Message switching is best known by the descriptive term store and forward.

In this mechanism, a node(usually a special computer with a number of disks) receives a message, stores it until the appropriate route is free, then sends it along.

In this approach whole message is sent all together instead of small packets.

Note that in message switching, the message are stored and relayed from secondary storage (disk), while in packet switching the packets are stored and forwarded from primary memory (RAM).
The delays inherent in the process, as well as the requirements for large capacity storage media at each node make it unpopular for direct communication.

Figure 8.26 Message Switched Network

